

Hoot's Sleepy Rounds

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Hoot the owl had an important job. Every night he flew his sleepy rounds. He checked that every animal was tucked in. Only then could he go to sleep himself.

First he flew to the rabbit burrow. The baby bunnies were snuggled in a fluffy pile. Their mother had tucked them in tight. Hoot nodded. All good.

"All tucked in, hoot, hoot," he called softly.



Next he flew to the beaver lodge. The beaver kits were curled in their bark beds. One little kit was still wiggling. Hoot sang a soft hoot. The kit settled down.

"All tucked in, hoot, hoot," he called again.

Then he flew to the mouse hole. The mouse family was cozy in their thimble beds. The littlest mouse waved a sleepy paw. Hoot waved back with his wing.



Hoot felt proud. His rounds were going well. But he also felt a little sleepy himself. His wings were getting heavy. His eyes blinked slowly.

He flew to the fox den. The fox kits were dreaming already. One was chasing dream-butterflies. Its paws twitched happily. Hoot smiled.

"All tucked in, hoot, hoot," he called one last time.

Every animal was asleep. The meadow was quiet. The stars twinkled down. Hoot's job was done. Now it was his turn.



He flew home to his hollow tree. His nest was soft with feathers. He fluffed it up just right. He tucked his head under his wing.

But wait. Who would check that Hoot was tucked in? Just then, Mother Moon peeked through the leaves. She shone her gentle light on him.

"All tucked in, hoot, hoot," whispered the moon.



Hoot felt warm and loved. Even the checker gets checked. He closed his big round eyes. His breathing grew slow and deep.

The night was peaceful. Every animal dreamed softly. And Hoot dreamed the happiest dream of all. He dreamed he was flying through clouds made of pillows.

Sleep now, little owl. Your rounds are done. Everyone is safe, including you.

***Moral:** Those who care for others deserve to be cared for too.*

The End